Little Place Labs

Analyst: Will Murphy
Mentor: Michael Jones

Entrepreneur(s):	Bosco Lai, Gaurav Bajaj
Location:	Houston, TX
Founded:	2020
Raise Amount:	$2.66mm
Capacity:	$3mm
Deal Structure:	N/A
Pre-Money Value:	N/A
Post-Money Value:	N/A

Business Summary and Model

What does the company do? What is their business model? Problem they address/solution they provide?

Overview

- Little Place Labs is a SaaS company that speeds up process of capturing satellite imagery and delivering it to the end user
- Little Place Labs aims to deliver critical satellite imagery quickly to prevent Natural Disaster, defense and Finance commodity trading.

Problem

- Ground station waiting
    - Satellites can only transmit data when passing over ground stations, which occurs 4-6 per day according to arxiv research
- Limited Downlink Capacity
    - Low Earth Orbiting (LEO) satellites remain in ground station for 10 minutes at a time. Satellites can't transfer the terabytes of data they've generated in those brief windows
- Ground Processing and Manual Review
    - End users stick sifting through vast amounts of data to find the most relevant pieces, this creates downtime

Solution

- Remove ground downlink process and replace with data processing on the satellite with it called edge computing
- Edge computing involves AI/ML software thar allows for satellite image download to occur in space rather than on a ground station
- This reduces long processing delays, enabling the process to be completed in 7 minutes or less.
- Edge computing can reduce the amount of data being sent to ground stations which saves money on a per download basis

Traction

- 2024
    - Launched in orbit software that's being hosted by Loft Orbital's satellite (YAM-6), no detailed report on findings, this did show that Little Place labs can launch their software to existing Loft Satellites in space according to SpaceNews
    - Secured phase II contract from Air force around $1.8mm contract
- 2025
    - Formed Strategic partnership with Sidus Space and signed a Memorandum of Understanding, for ocean imagery awareness
    - 9 partner satellites added
    - launched prototype of OrbitfyVIEW the user interface platform
    - SpaceWERX awardee of $2mm tactical funding increase

Business Model

- Business-to-Business (B2B)
- Selling space data analytics to businesses
- Selling to B2B users including Satellite companies using a SaaS platform

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- Beyond government contracts what are your other revenue channels?
- How many satellites have you integrated with up to this point?
- What companies' satellites are you integrating your software into?
- What companies would be customers to your SaaS product?
- Do you currently have recurring revenue? Or is it just R&D contracts from the Air Force?
- Who owns the customer relationship? Is it you or the satellite companies you operate with?
- Is LPL paid per query, subscription, or flat licensing fee? How much would the service be?
- What are the cost savings of using in-orbit edge computing compared to the traditional method?

Analyst's Opinion:
Little Place Labs is addressing the critical bottleneck in satellite operations by reducing the time and cost associated with collecting and processing satellite imagery. The company has demonstrated early traction through strategic partnerships and successful in-orbit missions, including recent deployment in their software was able to filter out ~98% of raw satellite imagery data before downlink. I'm concerned about their long term business model, it appears up till now they've been funding R&D through 3Fs, VC funding, and Air Force contracts. Based on comparable competitors in space, a subscription based model, charging per month of annually seems most likely. A notable strength is the amount of capital they've raised indicating strong investor confidence.

Team

Entrepreneur's background? Past start-up or industry experience? Strengths and weaknesses? Team's ability to exit the business?

Management Team

- Bosco Lai - Founder
    - Venture Partner at Third Sphere - dealing with early stage investing focused on climate tech, sustainability, and companies
    - Venture Partner Urban Us Capital, institutionally backed credit fund that provides asset-backed financing to early and growth stage companies, primarily tech.
    - VP - Events at Space Force Association, is a non-profit dedicated to supporting U.S Space Force and broader national space force community.
- Gaurav Bajaj - Co-Founder & CTO
    - Software Engineer at Infosys Technologies ltd, and they are a digital services and consulting company that specialize in AI-powered, cloud, and software engineering
    - Cards & Payments Consultant/Manager at Accenture
    - Consultant /Manager at Nationwide Building Society, one of the largest member owned financial institutions in the UK.
    - Sr Consultant / Project Manager at Ripple, a fintech company founded in 2012 to help banks move money faster and cheaper across borders using blockchain technology.
    - Co-Founder of FoodGully, a platform that supports home chiefs by providing affordable home cooked healthy food founded in 2021.

Brian Barris – Director of GIS

- Systems Engineer / R&D Engineer at Northrop Grumman, an American aerospace and defense technology manufacturer and top five contractor for U.S government
- Senior Scientist at Electromagnetic systems, a defense technology company focused on radar, sensor fusion, and target tracking solutions for U.S government and aerospace clients.
- Senior Engineer / Solutions Engineer at Ursa Space Systems, a data analytics company focused on reducing latency and improving access to synthetic aperture radar (SAR) imagery for commercial and government customers
- 9 other team members

Advisors

- Syed Ghazanfar Shah
    - Engineering Associate at NASA
    - Manager, Manufacture ring Engineering at L3 Technologies, a major American defense contractor specializing electronic systems for military.
    - Sr Director, Engineering and Project Management at Spire, company that provides space-based data and analytics for tracking weather, maritime, and aviation.

    - Vice President of Business Development at Lucix Corporation, founded in 1999, designs, manufactures, and test radio frequency and microwave hardware for satellites.
- Ross Morrell
    - Commander for 627 Communications Squadron, USAF, dealing with IT/Networks/Cyber
    - Chief, Non-Rated Officer Assignments, Air Force Personnel Center.
    - Chief, Cybersecurity Division
    - Chief, Cloud Center of Excellence, managed DoD transportation for air, land and sea transportation (Link)
    - Chief, Cyber Operations Division & Director, JCC at NORAD & USNORTHCOM
    - Chief, Technology & Innovation Officer at NORAD & US Northern Command, a joint US and Canda organization responsible for aerospace monitoring
    - Retired U.S Air Force Colonel
- Charlie McGillis
    - Achieved Director of Intelligence, 14th Air Force Colonel with over two decades of experience with the United States Department of the Air Force
    - Featured as a top 30 Executive to watch in 2021 according to congress.gov
    - Commercial Integration Cell Liaison at CSpOC Commercial Integration Cell, a U.S Space Command initiative that works with commercial satellite operators to enhance space situational awareness
    - Board Member at Catalyst Campus Colorado Spring, a business that mentors' small businesses to scale and develop technologies for defense and aerospace.
    - Partner at Elara Nova, founded in 2023 a consulting firm that connects businesses and government agencies with opportunities in the U.S Space force.
    - Founder and CEO at 2 Polaris & Beyond, a consulting firm focused on national security space missions.

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- Your advisory board has impressive Air Force experience; can you walk me through how their experience and network directly supports your go-to-market strategy?
- Given your core product in AI-powered software, can you describe the technical background of your founding team? What's your in-house capability for developing machine learning and on-orbit processing algorithms versus what you outsource?
- What is your plan going forward with utilizing your Air Force connections?
- At your current scale what additional expertise do you think you need to bring onto the team to be successful?

Analyst's Opinion:
Little Place labs has a strong advisory board that features retired Air Force colonels that can help secure DoD contracts providing valuable credibility and access to additional government funding. Management team demonstrates solid business competency. However, the founding team's technical depth in aerospace software engineering and AI/ML development appears to be limited based on public information. A single individual possessing relevant technical expertise could present execution risks for the company since its core value proposition is advanced on-orbit AI/ML processing. Technical capability gaps could hinder future product development and could serve to be a struggle to differentiate themselves from competitors.

Fatal Flaw and Feasibility

Fatal flaw? Can the company survive without meeting projections? What will kill this deal or make it a home-run?

Fatal Flaw

- Survival of company is too dependent on a single government contract to keep them afloat, next contact phase is historically difficult to get.
    - Quote from Bosco Lai "path ahead is challenging and survival can depend on a single contract ", according to Wall Street Journal
- No key differentiator between their software and competitors

Kill this deal

- Not securing a DoD contract from the Air Force would kill LPL, they wouldn't be able to fund any more R&D, without clear business model they have no other sources of funding
- Unable to separate themselves from competitors, preventing them from being integrated with market leaders

Home-Run

- Secure Phase III U.S Air Force government contract
- Demonstrate clear value proposition through in-orbit testing to prove reliability
- Offer cheaper and better software than what currently on the market

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- How do you plan on separating yourself from your competitors?
- What are the next steps for securing another government contract?
- How do you plan on if at all receiving phase III Air force contracting?

Analyst's Opinion:
Little place Labs is heavily reliant on receiving funding, particularly from the Air Force to fund their R&D and train their AI models. Without a clearly defined business model, it seems they don't have a reliable source of revenue to support R&D. If LPL was to secure Phase III Air force government contract that would provide them with unlimited funding needs and no time limit on the contract. However, historically it is difficult to secure Phase III due to the required elements. As such, reliance on this pathway introduces execution and funding risk. Additionally, their value proposition isn't clear, I would like to ask them how they are different from

competitors, whether that is based on performance, cost, speed, reliability, or ease of integration will be important for their success.

Service

Product/Service Description? Features? Model/Process Map/Sample? Studies/Reviews?

Service Description

- Software that can speed up the time it takes to process satellite imagery with Artificial intelligence called Orbitfy

Features

- OrbityfyPREP - enhances imagery satellite operations
- OrbitfyEDGE - delivers space insights with 7 minutes on network of satellites to process images directly in space
- OrbitfyVIEW - Data visualization dashboard that allows users to task different satellites over different locations

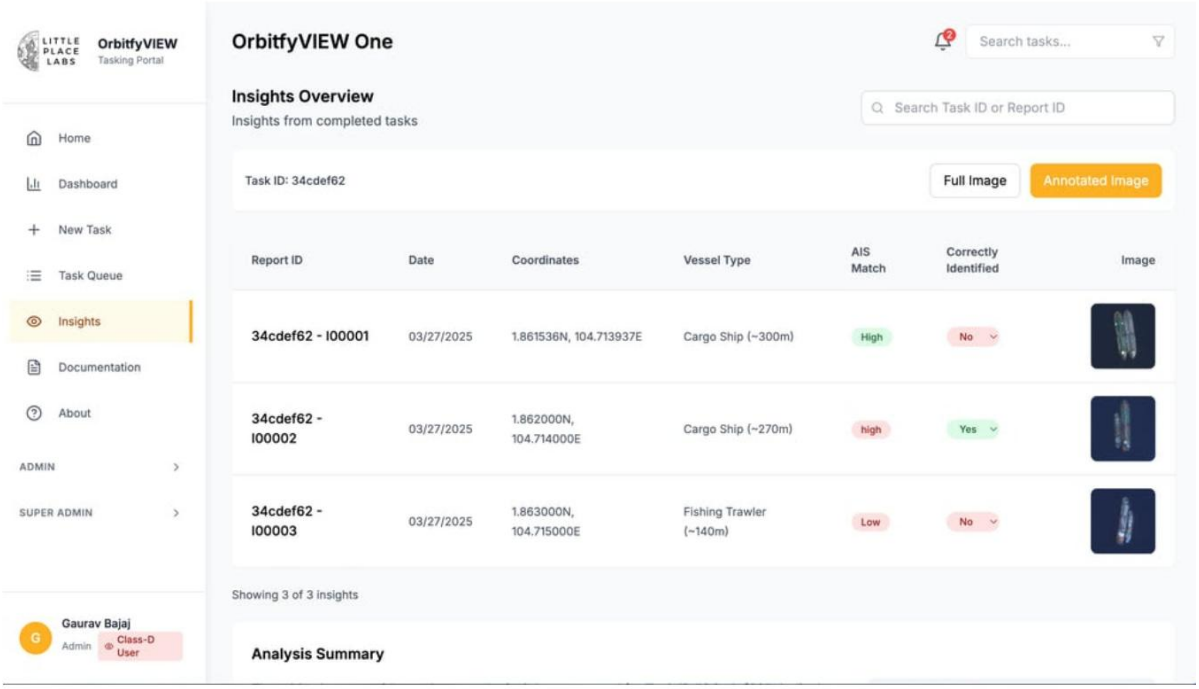
Process

- Images are captured by low earth orbit (LEO) Satellite
- Images are then processed in orbit on the satellite from Little Place Labs OrbitfyEDGE, AI will identify the specific anomaly (ship in restricted zone or forest fire), then downlinks the "thumbnail"
- Finally, it's delivered to OrbitfyVIEW the digital platform for the end user
- Entire process from image capture to end user is less than 7 minutes

Status Quo

- LEO satellites can take anywhere from hours to days to receive satellite imagery
- Process
    - Step 1: Image Capture
    - Step 2: Onboard Storage
    - Step 3: Wait for ground station contact
    - Step 4: Downlink to ground station
    - Step 5: Gound Processing according to TELECOMS

Model


OrbitfyVIEW
Tasking Portal
Home
Dashboard
New Task
Task Queue
Insights
Documentation
About
ADMIN
SUPER ADMIN
Gaurav Bajaj
Admin
Class-D User
OrbitfyVIEW One
Search tasks...
Insights Overview
Insights from completed tasks
Search Task ID or Report ID
Task ID: 34cdef62
Full Image
Annotated Image
Report ID
Date
Coordinates
Vessel Type
AIS Match
Correctly Identified
Image
34cdef62 - I00001
03/27/2025
1.861536N, 104.713937E
Cargo Ship (~300m)
High
No
34cdef62 - I00002
03/27/2025
1.862000N, 104.714000E
Cargo Ship (~270m)
high
Yes
34cdef62 - I00003
03/27/2025
1.863000N, 104.715000E
Fishing Trawler (~140m)
Low
No
Showing 3 of 3 insights
Analysis Summary



Study

- Successfully launched an in-orbit demonstration of Orbitfy according to D-orbit and LPL
    - Resulted in a 98% reduction in downlink data
    - This shows their AI/ML can sift through irrelevant data and present the end user with decision making satellite imagery, effectively eliminating decision latency

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- What is service differentiator?
- What have you validated up to this point with your software?
- What satellite companies are still using traditional satellite image downloading that you could target for software integration?
- How are you training your AI models? What are the associated cost with training you models?

Analyst's Opinion:
Little place Labs develops software designed to reduce satellite imagery latency by performing AI/ML based processing directly in orbit, minimizing data downlink and operational delays. This approach aligns with industry trends towards edge computing in space, LPL doesn't have anything differentiate themselves. One potential area of differentiation could be tighter integration with next-generation NIVDIA jetson Thor hardware, allowing LPL to optimize performance based on specific chips. Demonstrating superior speed, reliability, or efficiency could provide a meaningful competitive advantage. They've had good progression within orbit testing showing 98% reduction in data downlink.

Market

Who is the target customer? Size of target market? Accessible market? What is the go-to-market strategy? Cost of customer acquisition? Lifetime Value?

Size of Target Market

TAM

- Global Earth Observation (EO) market is valued at 5.1bn as of 2024 according to Grand View Research
- Satellite Earth Observation segment accounts for 76% of 5.1bn market
    - 5.1bn * 76% = 3.876bn total addressable market

SAM

- Low Earth Orbit accounts for ~60% of total EO Market
    - 5.1bn * 76% = 3.876bn * 60% = 2.33bn

SOM

- US Earth Observation accounts for 45% of the Global EO market
    - 2.33bn * 45% = 1.05bn

Go-to-Market

- Come to satellite manufacturing companies to test their software on their satellites

- Currently partners with Loft, Sidus Space and D-Orbit, which are satellite manufacturers

Target Customer

- U.S Department of Defense / Air Force
- Commercial maritime shipping companies
- Commodity trading companies

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- What customers from the commercial maritime shipping industry could you see selling to?
- Do you plan to sell directly to end customers, through partners, or via government contracts?
- What specific customers are interested in buying your SaaS platform?
- What is your Go-to-Market strategy?
- What prevents a well-funded competitor from replicating your approach?

Analyst's Opinion:

Current industry trends indicate growing adoption of AI in space-based applications, which is favorable for Little Place Labs. However, the company's end customer is not yet clearly defined, and it would be helpful to understand who they're engaging with. Their competitors generate revenue by selling services to foreign governments as a customer. Low Earth orbit (LEO) satellite market is growing which is good for ability to create new partnerships. Their go-to-market strategy remains unclear. I'd be interested to see how LPL intends to leverage its Air Force relationships to drive customer acquisition.

Industry and Competition

Who is the competition? Barriers to entry? Competitive Advantage? Does the company have strategic differentiation? What is the industry growth? Is this good timing for the opportunity?

Industry

- Global Earth Observation industry
    - Focus on Satellite software engineering and AI/ML edge computing

Trends

- Satellite based EO segment has the largest market share at 76% and is driving increases demand for high resolution data.
- Growing need for real-time insights, especially in disaster management
- UAV/Drone EO segment is expected to see highest CAGR growth over 10%
- Low Earth Orbit (LEO) segment accounted for the largest market share
- Increasing demand for real-time earth monitoring, specifically for disaster management and environmental monitoring.

Competitors

- Planet Labs
    - Publicly traded company founded in 2010
    - Develop own software doing the same thing as Little Place Labs, using on-orbit edge computing to overcome data bottlenecks, greatly accelerating ability to get actionable insights.

    - Don't need to pay satellite companies for software AI model training, they build their own satellites
- Vantor Holding
    - privately owned company acquired in 2023 by Advent International
    - Software focused, AI-enabled spatial intelligence company that provides end-to-end solutions for mapping, monitoring and analyzing Earth and Space
- SkyServe
    - Space AI and edge computing company empowering satellite operators to deploy AI-powered earth observation applications onboard
    - Serves exact product as Little Place Labs, has same partnerships as LPL

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- What current solutions exist for reducing satellite image latency, and how do they compare to your approach?
- How does your AI and edge computing approach differ from other companies attempting to solve similar problems?
- What broader markets or technological trends do you believe most strongly support the long term success of your approach?

Analyst's Opinion:
Little Place Labs operates in an increasingly competitive landscape, with several companies pursuing similar edge-computing capabilities for on-orbit data processing. Most notably, Skyserve appears to be executing a comparable strategy, including similar partnerships and in-orbit demonstration missions. LPL will need to clearly articulate a strong value proposition in order to differentiate itself meaningfully from competitors. Borad market indicators remain favorable, LEO satellite market continues to expand. I think LPL needs to establish a distinct operational advantage.

Funding and Scalability

Does the company have milestones? Are there additional SKUs/contracts/retailers? Economies of scale? How is this funding going to bring them to their next objective or exit? What are they focusing on that will bring them to scale? Marketing, efficacy studies, key sales partners, etc.
Funding

- Phase I AFWERX STTR Phase I x2, this phase is known as proof of concept
    - Highly competitive
- $1.8mm AFWERX STTR Phase II Contract
    - Requires signed MoU (formal agreement between AF customer and end user) for approval
    - End User is typically a warfighter that would use the technology, and a customer is a program officer with funding authority
- <$1mm from University of Oxford seed fund

- $2.18mm convertible Bridge loan in VC early-stage seed round from LEONID and Sand Hill North, LEONID is a California based VC firm, impressive 75% revenue growth in portfolio companies on average
- $0.12mm from Techstars, founded in 2006, venture capital fund that invests in early-stage startups, funded over $30bn in new start-ups
- Seeking $3mm, already have raised $2.66mm according to pitchbook, $0.34mm left in raise, deploy that capital for product advancement, satellite uploading and $10mm in revenue

Milestones

- 2027
    - Advance product to full readiness
    - Deploy their Software in 50+ satellites
    - $10mm in revenue

Exit

- No timeline on their exit
- Expected to be acquired by the following
    - Defense primes (companies that receive big DoD contracts)
    - Satellite operators
    - AI/Cloud Giants seeking to own space-based edge computing

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- What actions are you taking to deploy 50+ satellites?
- How many satellites are you currently in?
- What's the next step of funding, is Phase III Air force contract the next step?
- What does having your product in full operational readiness look like? How will that be measured?
- Who are your key sales partners?

Analyst's Opinion:
Securing a phase II Air Force contract is a strong validation point, as it demonstrates both government interest and confidence in Little Place Labs technology for practical use cases. The amount of funding the company has raised to date is also notable upwards of $4mm, with backing from venture capital LEONID a reputable VC firm, Phase I and Phase II Air Force contracts. This level of support reflects meaningful traction, particularly within government and defense. I'm curious about the company's path to commercialization, and with no current meaningful revenue, it raises some uncertainty of their goal of reaching $10mm by 2027. Additionally, LPL plans to deploy in more than 50+ satellite deployments, greater clarity would be helpful in understanding their execution timeline, customer commitments, and how those deployments could turn into recurring revenue.

Financial Projections

What are the assumptions? What are the cost drivers? Does the model make sense? Is sales growth believable? What is the burn rate? Do they consider cash on hand? When will they need to raise additional capital?

Never Received Financials

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Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

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Analyst's Opinion:

Deal Structure and Valuation

Is there a lead investor? Are the terms set? What are the terms? Is there a board seat available?

Never Received Financials

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Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

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Analyst's Opinion:

Exit Opportunity

How does the entrepreneur view the exit opportunity? Do they have particular companies or strategies in mind? Is there M&A activity in the industry?

Exit Strategy

- No timeline on their exit

Potential Acquirers

- Defense Primes
    - Lockheed Martin is a global aerospace, defense, and advanced technologies company
        - Big presence in space systems, develop own in-house AI models for satellites.
    - Northrop Grumman is a major aerospace and defense technology company
        - According to their website they are actively finding ways to implement machine learning and AI into, space, maritime defense, etc
        - Recently teamed up with Luminary Cloud tech start-up with hopes to reduce time it takes to design and develop space systems according to airandspaceforces
- Satellite operators

    - Sidus Space is a space-as-a-service company focusing on satellite manufacturing, payload integration and space-based data solutions
    - Currently signed a memorandum of understanding, shows interest and intent to use Little Place Labs software

Recent Deals

- Advent International acquired Vantor Holdings for $6.4bn in May 2023
    - Vantor Holdings is a software focused, AI-enabled spatial intelligence company that provides end-to-end solutions for mapping, monitoring and analyzing Earth and Space

Questions for Entrepreneur or Mentor:

- Who are your potential Defense Prime acquirers?
- What is your exit timeline?
- What is the most likely acquisition out of defense primes, satellite operators, and AI/Cloud giants?

Analyst's Opinion:

Little Place Labs does not currently have a defined timeline for an exit, though their pitch deck has identified several potential acquirers across defense, satellite operators, and AI/Cloud giants. At this stage, the most likely outcome will depend on the company's ability to further sharpen its value proposition and clearly differentiate itself from existing competitors in the space. Their founding team appears to be highly committed to building the business, as evidenced by their consistent participation in industry competitions and partnership development. The level of involvement suggests strong execution focus and long-term commitment to scaling the company.